

DOMAIN 04

AI / ML

D4-PS1

The CA in Your Pocket That Does Not Exist

BACKGROUND

India has 1.4 crore GST-registered MSMEs. A kirana store owner in Lucknow receives 500 to 2,000 invoices per month via WhatsApp images, printed digital invoices, machine-generated receipts, and scanned PDFs. They currently pay 15,000 to 40,000 rupees per month to a chartered accountant who manually enters this data into GST portals. The CA's real value is not data entry. It is knowing that a specific invoice carries the wrong HSN code and that fixing it will unlock 2,400 rupees in blocked Input Tax Credit this month.

THE PROBLEM

The GST portal offers no diagnostic tool that explains what is mismatched, why it matters, and what action to take in plain language. A small trader who tries to file independently misses ITC claims they are legally entitled to and loses real money every month. The core issue is an unstructured data paradox coupled with a language barrier. The reality of a small business is physical and messy while government compliance is digital and rigidly structured. Traders lack a bridge to translate their daily commercial artifacts into actionable compliance realities without paying a professional gatekeeper.

CONSTRAINTS

- GST portal backend APIs are not available to third-party developers.
- The target user has a smartphone but limited comfort with English interfaces.
- Output must be directly actionable by the trader without requiring professional interpretation.

Simulation Clause: *The trader's own GSTR-2B export, which any registered taxpayer can download directly from the portal as a PDF or spreadsheet, is a valid and available baseline. For prototyping purposes teams may generate their own clean dummy GSTR-2B datasets (CSV or Excel) rather than relying on actual government portal downloads.*
